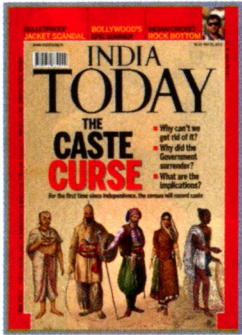


The Caste Curse

MAY 24, 2010

India is a country of a thousand castes where desperate politics plays out its salvation script. The caste-based Census 2011, endorsed by the moderniser prime minister, is bound to further accelerate the social Balkanisation of India.



“Our politicians should allow the census to take place in the best scientific method and then evolve a development package based on income-caste combination, not just on one of them.”

JVV MURTHY, Coimbatore

The Step Backward

The cover story provides immense potential for sociological research (“The Caste Curse”, May 24). Parliament rightly ended its recent session with the home minister remarking that the caste phenomenon is a reality with high divisive factors. Caste has been an instrumental aspect of state policy from time immemorial. At this juncture, not just the Government but research scholars and intellectuals should express their concerns over the caste-based census.

PROF. RAMESH SINHA, Delhi

The lead article has rightly dubbed India as a caste country as the curse of caste is fully upon us and nothing, including the Census 2011, remains untouched by it. For the



Reliance on Family

The Supreme Court judgement is a balanced one with far-reaching implications that two individual litigant-parties have no right over a commodity controlled by the Government (“Government is the Big Brother”, May 24). The directions for re-negotiation gave a healing touch to the fighting parties for settlements keeping in view the fact that the Government-controlled gas cannot be made a subject of dispute between private parties.

SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL, Delhi

The clash of the Ambani brothers is a lesson for family businesses. Such a conflict is inevitable as an individual feels the need to stand on his feet. The worst competition comes from siblings if both are in the same business.

MAHESH KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

Indian politician who plays the caste card at every political turn, it is a gift from heaven. For the lower castes, it is a magic wand to extract maximum concessions from the state. And as long as caste calls the shots, this country will never progress.

VIJAYALAKSHMI A.,
via www.indiatoday.in

Just when we thought we had rid ourselves of this horrendous system of dividing people on the basis of their caste, it seems to be coming back to haunt us. The Government is being driven by the ‘Y’ factor or the Yadav force. Whether it was in the past or now, the motive is the same—divide people in order to benefit a chosen few. The inclusion of caste in the census is an extremely

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